

Link Unlinked

Q When I click on a hyperlink—or if I right-click on one and select Open in New Window—nothing happens, or a blank window opens. I use Windows XP SP2 and IE6.

Durgesh Parakh

A This can happen when certain files in Windows are improperly registered. Quit all running programs. Run `regsvr32 urlmon.dll`. You should receive the “DllRegisterServer in urlmon.dll succeeded” message. If this does not resolve the problem, repeat the `regsvr32` command for each of the following files: `Shdocvw.dll`, `Actxprxy.dll`, `Oleaut32.dll`, `Mshtml.dll`, `Browseui.dll`, and `Shell32.dll`. Restart your computer for the changes to take effect.

The Gift Of The Tab

Q My Display Properties does not display the Desktop tab... why?

Saurabh Sikdar

A Your problem is likely caused by improper Group Policy settings. To restore the Desktop tab, run `gpedit.msc`. Navigate to User Configuration > Administrative Templates > Windows Components > Windows Explorer. In the right pane, double-click Turn On Classic Shell. Set the radio button to Not Configured and click OK.

It's My Business!

Q I share my XP computer with my younger brother, who fiddles with my settings. I use Outlook Express and want to prevent him from making changes to my account settings.

Balbir Sandhu

A Make sure your brother doesn't read this! In the Registry Editor, navigate to `HKEY_LOCAL_MACHINE\SOFTWARE\Microsoft\Outlook Express`. Modify or create a DWORD Value called No Modify Accts.

Giving it a value of 1 will mean no modifications will be allowed, and 0 will reverse that.

Into The Void

Q The Device Manager on my computer appears empty. I use Windows XP Pro.

Rasik Mehta

A A blank Device Manager window appears if the Plug and Play service is turned off or disabled. Just re-enable the service: run `services.msc`. Double-click Plug and Play. If you receive a Configuration Manager dialog, just click OK. In the Startup Type list, select Automatic. Close the Service Manager and restart.

Exit Interrupted

Q Whenever I try to shut down my computer, I get a message: “DEVLD R Not Responding.” When I click End Now, the computer stops responding and I

am unable to shut down Windows safely. I have a Pentium II processor, and I recently installed a LeadTek WinFast TV-Tuner and a Creative SoundBlaster Live! card.

Neeraj Baweja

A Uninstall the Creative SoundBlaster Live! driver and install the default one that came with XP (you may be prompted to insert your XP CD). Your sound card will not work with this driver; you need to install a patch from <http://www.softwrepatch.com/utilities/creative-live3.html>. Your problem should be solved.

Who Am I?

Q When I open System Properties, I get an error message: “Application has failed to start because Framedyn.dll was not found.”

M Jamadagni

A Either Framedyn.dll is damaged or missing, or the Windows Path environment variable does not point to the `%SYSTEMROOT%\System32\Wbem` folder. This requires you to:

Replace the Framedyn.dll file: In the Run dialog box, type in `%systemroot%\system32\dlcache` and click OK. Copy `framedyn.dll`. Then type `%systemroot%\system32\Wbem` into the Run dialog box and click OK. Paste your file there. Click Yes if you are prompted to replace the existing file.

Verify system variables: Right-click on My Computer and select Properties. You may get an error message; just click OK. Under the Advanced tab, click Environment Variables. Under System Variables, click Edit. If no Path variable is listed, click New. In the Variable name box, type Path. In the Variable value box, type `%SystemRoot%\system32; %SystemRoot%; %SystemRoot%\System32\Wbem`. Click OK three times.

Confound These Formats!

Q In AVI to DVD software, while converting VCD files to DVD format, the audio stream box is blank. It doesn't show the audio formats. VCDs are generally of the DAT file format. Are AVI and DAT of the same type? Please tell me how to convert VCD into DVD format and vice versa.

Vipul Shah

A DVD audio streams usually consist of six audio channels, and are Dolby Digital encoded. To decode the audio, you need to have the appropriate AC3 filters installed. If you don't the DVD audio cannot be decoded, so you're unable to see anything in the audio stream box. You can download the free AC3 filters from <http://ac3filter.sourceforge.net>. Alternatively, you may also download and install DVD players such as CyberLink PowerDVD 6 (www.cyberlink.com) or InterVideo WinDVD (www.intervideo.com).

The DAT format is different from AVI. DAT is an implementation of the MPEG-1 format, whereas AVI is the native video format used by Windows. You can use software such as Nero Vision Express (bundled with Nero CD/DVD burning software) to convert VCD to DVD and vice-versa. You can also use TMPGEnc from www.tmpegenc.net/e_download.html. ☐

